

The background features a light beige color with several abstract, textured elements. On the left, there are overlapping squares in shades of pink and grey, with thin grey lines radiating from a central point. In the center, three large, overlapping, textured yellow circles are arranged horizontally. On the right, there is a teal-colored square with a white rectangular cutout, and several curved teal lines looping around it.

Shikhar: A Leadership Coaching Journey for Women Professionals

Session 5

Today's session....

Sessions	Focus Areas	Areas covered
Session 1	Leadership Vision	Define leadership purpose and values; set intentions for the program.
Session 2	Leading Self	Identify inner strengths and limiting beliefs; reframe inner narratives.
Session 3	Career Strategy	Map career trajectory and success markers.
Session 4	Influence & Visibility	Develop influence strategies within your organization.
Session 5	Communication for Impact	Build executive presence through communication.
Session 6	Networking & Support & Future Path	Leverage mentorship and sponsorship for growth. Create an action plan and celebrate growth.
Session 7	1-1 Sessions	20 min session
Session 8	1-1 Sessions	20 min session

- Each session ~55 mins
- Interactive
- Group learn
- Introspective
- Guest Speaker

Leaders with strong presence...



What they do:

**Inspire, Energize, Build Trust,
Influence,
Make an Impact, Stand their
Ground**



How they communicate:

**With Confidence, Clarity,
Authenticity, Energy, Empathy,
Courage, Poise**



What they are skilled at:

**Public Speaking, Storytelling,
Managing Public Presence**

Why being a good leader won't get you promoted

I learned this the hard way.

For a long time, I believed:

If I build strong teams, develop people, prevent escalation and absorb pressure, someone will notice.

They didn't.

Not because the work wasn't good.

But because leadership inside your layer is invisible above it.

Executives could describe my results.

They couldn't describe my leadership.

Your boss sees outcomes.

Not the trust you build.

Not the conflicts you stop before they escalate.

Not the pressure you absorb so others can perform.

And the higher you climb,

the less your real leadership is visible.

Here's the uncomfortable truth:

Promotion is not a reward.

It's a risk decision.

At the next level, people don't ask:

"Is this person a good leader?"

They ask:

Can they handle exposure?

Political complexity?

Power?

Scrutiny?

If the room doesn't know how you think under pressure, you're not a safe bet.

This is where strong leaders get stuck.

Under hierarchy pressure, they retreat into silent overperformance.

They tell themselves:

"I don't play politics."

"My work should speak for itself."

It sounds principled.

It's avoidance.

Because visibility invites judgment.

And judgment threatens the ego.

So they stay excellent.

And invisible.

I've seen brilliant leaders stuck for years.

Not because they lacked competence.

But because they shrank in rooms with senior executives.

Too much awe.

Too much hesitation.

Too much respect for titles.

If you enter the room already smaller, you confirm the hierarchy before anyone else does.

Real confidence isn't arrogance.

It's behavioural stability under status pressure.

At senior levels, the decision circle is small.

And inside that circle, invisible leadership does not exist.

Being good is internal.

Being promotable is visible.

If people above you can't describe how you operate under pressure, you don't lack competence.

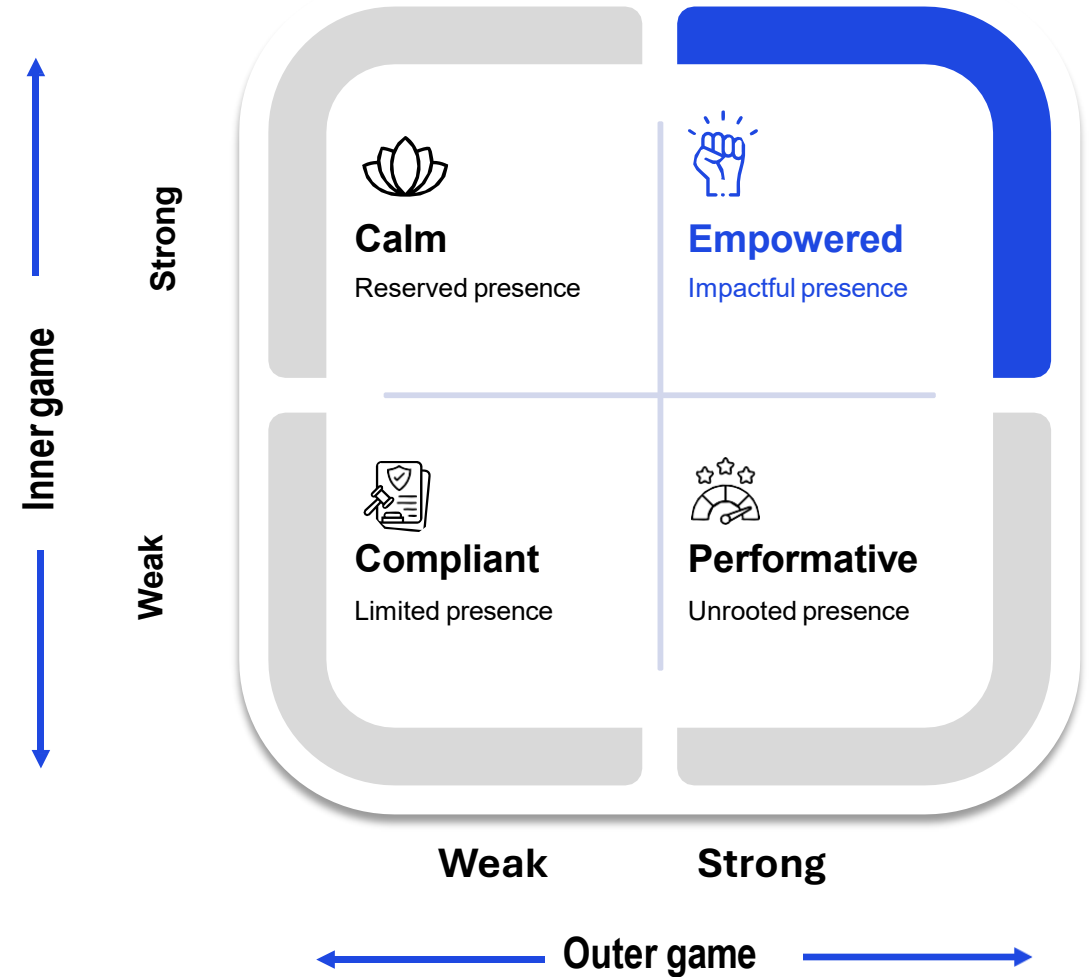
You lack strategic visibility.

And at that level, invisibility isn't bad luck.

It's positioning.

Impactful leadership presence

...is not just a function of communication and appearance. It is about the gravitas that is brought forth only when there is inner poise





No New Exercise

Refine and create your 6 mth-12 mth plan

Vision, Goals

Clear measurable, achievable milestones

Plan with Strengths to leverage, beliefs to overcome, skills gaps to fulfil

Stakeholder engagement plan

What counts as success

How will you stay true to your plan